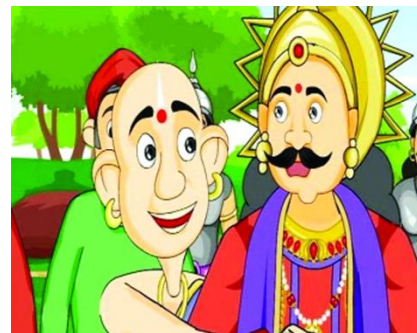


The ancient art of storytelling remains a vital medium for teaching values and fostering cultural understanding

Folklores, the traditional stories, myths, and legends passed down through generations, **have** long been a source of **fascination**, serving as much more than **mere** entertainment. Folklores **often centre on** ordinary people who face **adversity** yet find ways to **overcome** it, **reflecting** everyday life's common struggles and **aspirations**. This **relatability** comforts those who feel **isolated** in their struggles, showing that they are not alone and that their challenges are shared across time and place.



One of folklore's most significant **aspects** **is** its **inherent** simplicity, which makes it a powerful tool for education across generations. Folklores are often **crafted** to be relatable, **encapsulating** moral lessons or practical **wisdom** in a format accessible to children and adults alike. This accessibility makes folklore an effective educational medium, especially in regions where formal education might be limited.

Through **memorable** characters, narratives, and morals, folklores teach honesty, bravery, kindness, and **empathy** lessons crucial to shaping young minds. Folklore holds a unique power: it reflects past wisdom, inspires **critical thinking**, and provides a mirror for **self-reflection**.

Indian folklore is a **repository** of India's **diverse** cultural heritage. They act as a **unifying** force in a country as diverse as India, with **numerous** languages, religions, and social norms. They capture the **essence** of various regional traditions, **dialects**, and beliefs, **weaving** together the **vast** and **varied** **ethos** of the country.

Every region, from Kashmir to Kanyakumari, **has** tales that **embody** local wisdom, rituals, and social customs. **Stories** like those from the Panchatantra and Jataka Tales **have transcended** regions, becoming **staples** of Indian storytelling that educate on universal values while **highlighting** India's unique cultural **tapestry**.

Indian folklore frequently **addresses** social issues, challenging established norms and encouraging reflection on **societal** practices. **For instance**, the **folktales** of Tenali Rama, the **witty** advisor in the Vijayanagara Empire, often **question** the **elite's excesses** and promote justice for the common man. Similarly, **Birbal**, a **wise** minister in the Mughal court, **features** in numerous tales that promote **intellectual** equality. These stories teach Indians to value **wit**, intelligence, and fairness, subtly questioning the authority of those in power.

By **embedding** reformist ideas within entertaining narratives, Indian folklores provide a soft yet powerful **critique** of societal **hierarchies**, encouraging progressive thinking.

Many Indian folklore **emphasize** the bond between humans and nature, **imparting** lessons on environmental **stewardship** that **resonate** with India's **agrarian** roots. **Stories** about **sacred** rivers, protective spirits, or **revered** animals **highlight** the belief that natural entities are to be respected and cared for.

These tales often highlight shared human experiences, **bridging** cultural **gaps** and fostering a sense of collective identity. Folklore serves as a **reservoir** of collective wisdom, **transcending** time and geography to educate and reform society. Its remarkable **ability** to touch hearts, **prompt** reflection, and inspire action **makes** it **indispensable** in both formal and informal education. In an **era** dominated by digital technology, folklore may seem **antiquated**, yet its **relevance** has only deepened. Modern storytellers, educators, and social reformers can **adapt** folklore for **contemporary** audiences, **harnessing** its **emotive** power to foster empathy and awareness. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Vital** (adjective) – Essential, crucial, critical, fundamental, indispensable अत्यावश्यक
2. **Foster** (verb) – Encourage, promote, nurture, cultivate, support प्रोत्साहित करना
3. **Fascination** (noun) – Attraction, allure, captivation, enchantment, intrigue आकर्षण
4. **Mere** (adjective) – Simple, sheer, only, just, bare मात्र
5. **Often** (adverb) – Frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly, habitually अक्सर
6. **Center on** (phrasal verb) – Focus on, concentrate on, revolve around, hinge on, be based on पर केंद्रित होना
7. **Adversity** (noun) – Hardship, difficulty, misfortune, trouble, challenge विपत्ति
8. **Overcome** (verb) – Conquer, defeat, surmount, prevail over, triumph over पर काबू पाना
9. **Reflect** (verb) – Mirror, display, show, indicate, manifest प्रतिबिंबित करना
10. **Aspiration** (noun) – Ambition, goal, desire, aim, objective महत्वाकांक्षा
11. **Relatability** (noun) – Connection, resonance, identification, relevance, empathy संबद्धता
12. **Isolated** (adjective) – Alone, solitary, secluded, detached, separated अलग-थलग
13. **Aspect** (noun) – Feature, facet, component, element, characteristic पहलू
14. **Inherent** (adjective) – Innate, intrinsic, natural, built-in, essential अंतर्निहित
15. **Craft** (verb) – Create, make, fashion, construct, design निर्माण करना
16. **Encapsulate** (verb) – Summarize, condense, epitomize, embody, enclose सारांश करना
17. **Wisdom** (noun) – Knowledge, insight, sagacity, understanding, prudence ज्ञान
18. **Memorable** (adjective) – Unforgettable, notable, remarkable, noteworthy, impressive स्मरणीय
19. **Empathy** (noun) – Compassion, understanding, sympathy, rapport, sensitivity सहानुभूति
20. **Critical thinking** (noun) – Analytical reasoning, logical thinking, problem-solving, evaluation, rational thought सामरिक सोच
21. **Self-reflection** (noun) – Introspection, self-examination, contemplation, self-analysis, meditation आत्मचिंतन

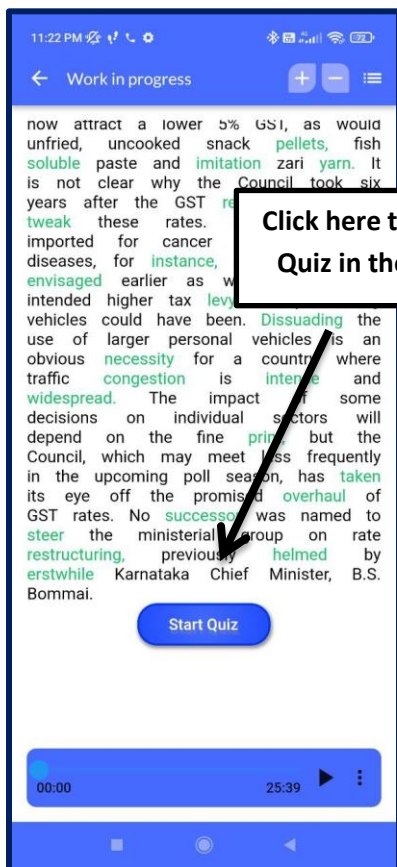
22. **Repository** (noun) – Storehouse, archive, treasury, collection, depository भंडार
23. **Diverse** (adjective) – Various, varied, different, assorted, heterogeneous विविध
24. **Unifying** (adjective) – Integrating, harmonizing, consolidating, connecting, combining एकीकरण करने वाला
25. **Numerous** (adjective) – Many, countless, several, myriad, abundant असंख्य
26. **Essence** (noun) – Core, substance, spirit, heart, nature सार
27. **Dialect** (noun) – Vernacular, language, idiom, regional speech, local tongue बोली
28. **Weave** (verb) – Intertwine, knit, interlace, blend, interweave बुनना
29. **Vast** (adjective) – Extensive, immense, huge, enormous, expansive विशाल
30. **Varied** (adjective) – Diverse, assorted, mixed, different, multifarious विविध
31. **Ethos** (noun) – Spirit, character, culture, philosophy, values प्रकृति
32. **Embody** (verb) – Represent, personify, exemplify, incarnate, manifest अवतार लेना
33. **Transcend** (verb) – Surpass, exceed, go beyond, rise above, overcome पार करना
34. **Staple** (noun) – Mainstay, essential, basic, fundamental, primary item मुख्य वस्तु
35. **Highlight** (verb) – Emphasize, underscore, spotlight, accentuate, stress प्रमुखता देना
36. **Tapestry** (noun) – Mosaic, intricate design, complex pattern, fabric, weaving जटिल मिश्रण
37. **Address** (verb) – Tackle, deal with, confront, handle, attend to सामना करना
38. **Societal** (adjective) – Social, communal, collective, public, societal सामाजिक
39. **For instance** (phrase) – For example, such as, to illustrate, as an illustration, e.g. उदाहरण के लिए
40. **Witty** (adjective) – Clever, humorous, amusing, sharp, quick-witted चतुर
41. **Elite** (noun) – Upper class, aristocracy, high society, ruling class, privileged few अभिजात वर्ग
42. **Excesses** (noun) – outrageous or immoderate behaviour. ज्यादातियों
43. **Wise** (adjective) – Knowledgeable, sage, learned, insightful, prudent बुद्धिमान
44. **Feature** (verb) – Include, present, showcase, display, exhibit प्रदर्शित करना
45. **Intellectual** (adjective) – Mental, cerebral, scholarly, academic, thoughtful बौद्धिक

46. **Wit** (noun) – Humor, cleverness, sharpness, intelligence, ingenuity विनोद बुद्धि
47. **Subtly** (adverb) – Delicately, finely, slightly, discreetly, imperceptibly सूक्ष्मता से
48. **Embed** (verb) – Insert, implant, fix, ingrain, incorporate सम्मिलित करना
49. **Critique** (noun) – Analysis, evaluation, review, assessment, criticism समीक्षा
50. **Hierarchy** (noun) – Ranking, order, chain of command, pecking order, ladder पदानुक्रम
51. **Emphasise** (verb) – Highlight, stress, underline, accentuate, underscore ज़ोर देना
52. **Impart** (verb) – Convey, communicate, transmit, bestow, pass on प्रदान करना
53. **Stewardship** (noun) – Management, care, supervision, guardianship, responsibility संरक्षण
54. **Resonate** (verb) – Echo, reverberate, ring true, strike a chord, connect गूंजना
55. **Agrarian** (adjective) – Agricultural, rural, farming, countryside, pastoral कृषि संबंधी
56. **Sacred** (adjective) – Holy, divine, hallowed, consecrated, revered पवित्र
57. **Revered** (adjective) – Respected, esteemed, venerated, honored, admired पूजनीय
58. **Bridge the gap** (phrase) – Connect, reconcile, link, close the distance, bring together फासला कम करना
59. **Reservoir** (noun) – Store, supply, pool, collection, repository भंडार
60. **Transcend** (verb) – Surpass, exceed, go beyond, rise above, overcome पार करना
61. **Prompt** (adjective) – Quick, immediate, swift, timely, punctual तत्काल
62. **Indispensable** (adjective) – Essential, necessary, vital, crucial, fundamental अनिवार्य
63. **Era** (noun) – Period, age, epoch, time, generation युग
64. **Antiquated** (adjective) – Old-fashioned, outdated, obsolete, archaic, ancient पुरातन
65. **Relevance** (noun) – Significance, importance, pertinence, applicability, connection प्रासंगिकता
66. **Adapt** (verb) – Adjust, modify, alter, acclimate, tailor अनुकूलित करना
67. **Contemporary** (adjective) – Modern, current, present-day, up-to-date, recent आधुनिक
68. **Harness** (verb) – Utilize, employ, use, exploit, channel उपयोग करना
69. **Emotive** (adjective) – Emotional, moving, stirring, affecting, touching भावनात्मक

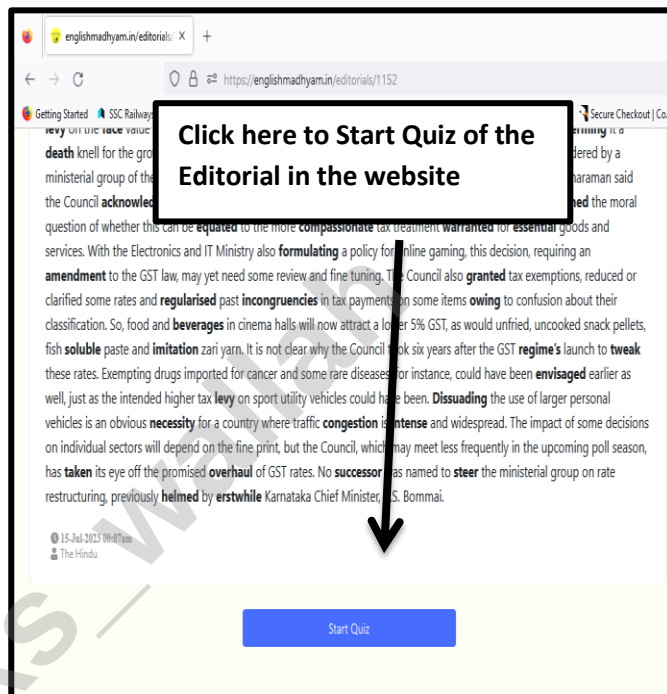
Summary of the Editorial

1. Storytelling remains an essential medium for teaching values and enhancing cultural understanding.
2. Folklores—traditional stories, myths, and legends—offer more than just entertainment; they serve educational and cultural purposes.
3. Folklores often portray ordinary individuals overcoming adversity, resonating with common human struggles.
4. The relatability of folklores provides comfort and a sense of shared experience for people across different eras and regions.
5. The simplicity of folklore stories makes them effective educational tools, accessible to both children and adults.
6. Folklore is particularly impactful in regions with limited formal education, teaching moral and practical lessons.
7. Through memorable characters and narratives, folklore imparts values like honesty, bravery, kindness, and empathy.
8. Folklores act as mirrors for self-reflection and critical thinking, blending past wisdom with present-day relevance.
9. Indian folklore preserves the country's diverse cultural heritage, fostering unity in a highly diverse society.
10. Regional tales from across India embody local wisdom and customs, reinforcing the country's cultural identity.
11. Collections like the Panchatantra and Jataka Tales convey universal values while celebrating India's cultural diversity.
12. Indian folktales often address social issues, subtly challenging norms and encouraging societal reflection.
13. Characters like Tenali Rama and Birbal illustrate values of justice, intellectual equality, and critique of the elite.
14. Many Indian folklores emphasize environmental stewardship, reflecting India's agrarian traditions and respect for nature.
15. In today's digital age, folklore remains relevant, with modern storytellers adapting it to foster empathy and awareness.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



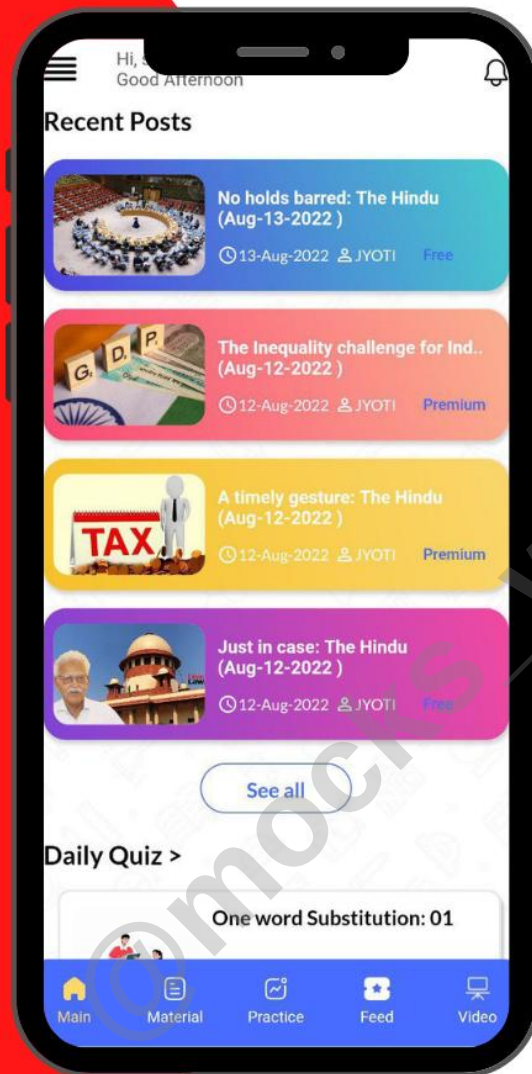
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